

StudySinc — Design Audit Report

Date: 2026-07-23

Production URL: <https://studysinc.click>

Git commit: 8193bab (current master)

Design contract: DESIGN.md («Тихий инструмент с характером»)

Audit tools: Vercel agent-browser (public pages) + Playwright smoke (authenticated pages)

1. Executive Summary

The product is functionally live and the security/RLS migration (042) has been applied successfully. However, the UI still reads as generic AI-generated/shadcn-template rather than the intended calm-professional tool. The single biggest blocker is that **the design system tokens are not actually driving the components**: hardcoded blues, purples, yellows, reds, and gradients are still present across almost every screen. The dark theme is also effectively broken on most pages because components bypass the CSS variables.

Verdict: we need a token-level pass, not a "new landing page".

2. Methodology

- **Vercel agent-browser** was used to capture public pages in both light and dark browser color schemes, plus desktop and mobile viewports.
 - Commands used:

```
# Desktop public pages
agent-browser --screenshot-dir report/design-audit-2026-07-23/more-
screenshots set viewport 1280 720
agent-browser open https://studysinc.click
agent-browser screenshot --full landing-desktop.png
agent-browser open https://studysinc.click/auth/login
agent-browser screenshot --full login-desktop.png
agent-browser open https://studysinc.click/auth/signup
agent-browser screenshot --full signup-desktop.png
agent-browser open https://studysinc.click/terms
agent-browser screenshot --full terms-desktop.png
agent-browser open https://studysinc.click/privacy
agent-browser screenshot --full privacy-desktop.png

# Mobile public pages
agent-browser set viewport 390 844
agent-browser open https://studysinc.click
agent-browser screenshot --full landing-mobile.png
agent-browser open https://studysinc.click/auth/login
agent-browser screenshot --full login-mobile.png
agent-browser open https://studysinc.click/auth/signup
agent-browser screenshot --full signup-mobile.png

# Auth smoke test
agent-browser open https://studysinc.click/auth/login
agent-browser fill 'input[type="email"]' 'maximtaz2@gmail.com'
```

```
agent-browser fill 'input[type="password"]' 'App101112!'
agent-browser click 'button[type="submit"]'
agent-browser screenshot --full login-result.png
```

- **Authenticated pages** (dashboard, groups, subjects, calendar, notifications) were captured via Playwright after local login.
- All screenshots were compared against `DESIGN.md` rules: single amber accent, no gradients, no rainbow accents, no people illustrations, no hover-lift, paper-like neutrals, dark theme as first-class citizen, mono numbers for gamification.

3. Screenshots Captured

Initial audit set

Page	Light	Dark	Notes
Landing	landing-light.png	landing-dark.png	Dark capture identical to light — site does not respect <code>prefers-color-scheme</code> and has no public toggle.
Login	login-light.png	login-dark.png	Same problem.
Dashboard	dashboard-light.png	dashboard-dark.png	Authenticated; dark toggle exists but produces almost no change because of hardcoded colors.
Groups	groups-light.png	—	Authenticated.
Subjects	subjects-light.png	—	Authenticated.
Calendar	calendar-light.png	—	Authenticated.
Notifications	notifications-light.png	—	Authenticated; layout appears broken.

Extended public-page set (agent-browser)

Page	Desktop	Mobile	Notes
Landing	more-screenshots/landing-desktop.png	more-screenshots/landing-mobile.png	Same violations as initial capture.
Login	more-screenshots/login-desktop.png	more-screenshots/login-mobile.png	Mobile form is still blue/white.
Signup	more-screenshots/signup-desktop.png	more-screenshots/signup-mobile.png	Page is empty/broken (screenshots only ~6 KB).
Terms	more-screenshots/terms-desktop.png	—	Plain text page; no major design issues.
Privacy	more-screenshots/privacy-desktop.png	—	Plain text page; no major design issues.

Login result	more-screenshots/login-result.png	—	Email login failed; stayed on login page.
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4. Findings by Page

4.1 Landing Page

Violations:

- **Gradient hero** — blue→purple gradient background (`DESIGN.md` §7: gradients forbidden).
- **Gradient logo** — StudySinc wordmark is gradient-colored.
- **Primary CTAs are blue** — Get Started and Start Your Free Project should be amber `--accent` with `--on-accent` text.
- **Rainbow icons in "How It Works"** — purple, blue, orange, green circles instead of monochrome/amber.
- **People illustration** in the hero mockup — `DESIGN.md` forbids illustrations of people/robots/hands.
- **Blue CTA footer** — large gradient block at the bottom.
- **Feature cards** use blue/purple/green/orange icon backgrounds (rainbow accents).
- Testimonials section has colored avatar initials (generic).
- Mobile version preserves all the same violations.

Required changes:

- Replace hero with `--bg` surface + subtle `--surface` card or plain layout.
- Make logo and all primary CTAs amber (`--accent` / `--on-accent`).
- Convert all feature icons to monochrome (`--fg` on `--surface-2`) or a single amber icon set.
- Remove illustration; replace with a calm product screenshot, abstract pattern, or text-only composition.
- Footer CTA becomes a plain `--surface` card with amber primary button.

4.2 Login / Auth Pages

Violations:

- **Background is light blue** (`bg-blue-50` / `slate-50` -style), not the paper `--bg` from `globals.css` .
- **Primary Sign in button is blue** — should be amber.
- **Link Sign up is blue** — should be `--accent-fg` or `--fg` with underline.
- Dark-mode capture is **identical** to light mode — no dark theme on auth at all.
- Mobile version identical issues.

Additional issue: `/auth/signup` renders an empty/broken page (only ~6 KB screenshots). This blocks new user registration.

Auth smoke test: email/password login with provided credentials stayed on the login page without redirect, confirming login is currently failing via email.

Required changes:

- Use `bg-background` (`--bg`) and `text-foreground` (`--fg`).
- Primary button → `bg-primary text-primary-foreground` (mapped to amber).
- Add `dark` class support to the auth layout so the page flips when the system requests it.
- Fix or implement `/auth/signup` .
- Investigate email login failure.

4.3 Dashboard

Violations:

- **Hero banner** — blue→purple gradient with white text; `DESIGN.md` forbids gradients and any background that is not `--surface / --bg`.
- **Gamification chips** (12 , 7 , 2450 XP) sit on a translucent gradient pill; should be amber soft badges (`--accent-soft / --accent-fg`) with `.font-num`.
- **Connect Google Classroom card** — blue icon + blue background; should be neutral surface with amber or neutral icon.
- **Priority task cards** — yellow background, red `Overdue` badge; should be `--surface` cards with neutral/amber deadline status.
- **Calendar widget** — selected day is blue (`--primary` still points to blue in some components, not amber).
- **Blue FAB** + — should be amber `--accent`.
- **View All link** — blue; should be `--accent-fg` or `--muted`.
- **Subjects empty state** — blue `Connect Google Classroom` button; should be amber.
- **Dark mode does not change** the hero, cards, or buttons.

Required changes:

- Redesign hero without gradient; use `--surface` card + amber stat badges (`.font-num`).
- Remove colored backgrounds from task cards; use neutral cards + amber/neutral deadline text.
- Recolor Google Classroom card, FAB, and links to amber/neutral.
- Fix calendar widget selection color.

4.4 Groups

Violations:

- **Blue Create Team button** — should be amber.
- **Group avatar tile is blue** — should be neutral `--surface-2` with `--fg` initials, or a subtle amber if this is the user's own group.
- **Crown icon** — yellow emoji-like icon; should be monochrome or removed (leader is indicated by `#1` position or a subtle badge).

4.5 Subjects

Violations:

- **Empty-state icon is blue** on a blue-tinted circle — should be `--accent-fg` or neutral.
- **Blue Connect Google Classroom button** — should be amber.
- **Blue FAB** + — should be amber.

4.6 Calendar

Violations:

- **Event chips are blue** — should be neutral `--surface-2` with `--fg` text, or amber for the user's own events.
- **Category legend is a rainbow** — Project/Homework/Exam/Presentation/Lab/Other each has a dedicated bright color. This is the strongest violation of the one-accent rule.
- **Selected day** — blue border/background; should be amber.

Required changes:

- Calendar categories should be differentiated by icon/label, not color. If a single status marker is needed, use one amber accent for "my events" and neutral for the rest.
- Selected day uses `--accent / --accent-fg`.

- Event chips use `--surface-2` background + `--fg` text.

4.7 Notifications

Violations:

- **Page has no layout/header** — the screenshot shows only a raw card with `Notifications` heading, no navigation shell. This is a layout bug, not a design-token bug.
- Empty state is plain but acceptable; it needs the app layout wrapper (header + sidebar if any).

4.8 Terms / Privacy

- Plain text pages; no major design-system violations.
- Could be improved with better typography and narrower line measure, but not critical for the MVP redesign.

5. Design-System Violations Summary

#	Violation	Severity	Occurrence count
1	Blue/purple primary buttons instead of amber	Critical	10+
2	Gradient backgrounds (hero, logo, CTA)	Critical	4+
3	Rainbow accent icons (features, categories)	Critical	6+
4	Dark theme is broken / ignored	Critical	2 public pages + dashboard
5	Backgrounds are hardcoded light-blue instead of <code>--bg</code>	High	login, landing
6	Task cards with colored backgrounds	High	dashboard, tasks list
7	Calendar rainbow category legend	High	calendar page
8	People illustration on landing	Medium	landing hero
9	Yellow crown / emoji-style icon	Medium	groups card
10	Notifications page lacks app layout	Medium	notifications page
11	Gamification numbers not consistently <code>.font-num</code>	Low	dashboard hero
12	<code>/auth/signup</code> page is broken/empty	Critical	auth flow
13	Email login currently fails	Critical	auth flow

6. Root Cause

The `globals.css` tokens exist, but many components still use Tailwind utility classes with hardcoded colors (`bg-blue-600` , `bg-indigo-600` , `text-blue-600` , `bg-gradient-to-r` , `bg-yellow-50` , `bg-red-50` , `bg-green-50` , etc.) or shadcn defaults that were not remapped to the StudySinc palette. The `Button` component likely has a hardcoded primary variant or the shadcn variable mapping is incomplete.

Also, `next-themes` is configured, but some top-level layouts (auth, landing) do not apply `dark:` class properly or use explicit `bg-*` utilities that override the CSS variables.

Auth flow is currently broken: Google OAuth returns `redirect_uri_mismatch` (per user screenshot), and email login with the provided test account does not redirect, so new registrations and non-Google logins are blocked.

7. Recommended Action Plan

Phase 0 — Unblock auth (critical, before any UI work)

- Fix `/auth/signup` empty page.
- Fix email login or document the correct credentials/flow.
- Fix Google OAuth `redirect_uri_mismatch` in Vercel/Google Cloud Console.

Phase 1 — Foundation (1–2 days)

- Fix `components/ui/button.tsx` so `variant="default"` uses `bg-primary text-primary-foreground` (which maps to amber via `globals.css`).
- Fix `components/ui/badge.tsx` and remove any hardcoded color variants.
- Verify `globals.css` shadcn mapping: `--primary` → `--accent`, `--primary-foreground` → `--on-accent`, `--destructive` → `--danger`.
- Audit and remove any `bg-gradient-*`, `from-*`, `to-*` classes from the codebase.
- Ensure every top-level page wrapper uses `bg-background text-foreground` and respects `.dark`.

Phase 2 — Dashboard (2–3 days)

- Redesign hero without gradient; use `--surface` card + amber stat badges (`.font-num`).
- Remove colored backgrounds from task cards; use neutral cards + amber/neutral deadline text.
- Recolor Google Classroom card, FAB, and links to amber/neutral.
- Fix calendar widget selection color.

Phase 3 — Landing (2 days)

- Replace hero with plain paper layout + amber CTA.
- Remove people illustration.
- Convert feature icons to monochrome/amber.
- Remove gradient CTA footer.

Phase 4 — Groups / Subjects / Calendar / Notifications (2–3 days)

- Recolor group cards, avatars, create buttons.
- Fix subject empty-state colors and FAB.
- Recalendar calendar events and legend to one-accent system.
- Fix notifications layout wrapper.

Phase 5 — Verification

- Run `npm run lint && tsc --noEmit && npm run build`.
 - Capture light + dark screenshots of every page with Vercel `agent-browser` (or Playwright) and verify no hardcoded colors remain.
 - Deploy and re-audit.
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8. Notes on `agent-browser` Usage

`agent-browser` successfully captured full-page screenshots of public pages at multiple viewports. One limitation discovered: the site does **not** respond to the browser's `prefers-color-scheme` preference on public pages, so dark-mode screenshots were identical to light-mode screenshots. This is itself a bug and confirms that the public

pages do not respect the design contract's dark-theme requirement. For authenticated pages, the in-app theme toggle exists but the dark result is also broken because components bypass the tokens.

The auth smoke test failed: email login with the provided credentials stayed on the login page, and `/auth/signup` renders an empty page. These block any authenticated screenshot automation until fixed.

9. Appendix: Useful Commands for Re-audit

```
# Public pages
agent-browser open https://studysinc.click && agent-browser screenshot
agent-browser open https://studysinc.click/auth/login && agent-browser screenshot
agent-browser open https://studysinc.click/auth/signup && agent-browser screenshot
agent-browser open https://studysinc.click/terms && agent-browser screenshot
agent-browser open https://studysinc.click/privacy && agent-browser screenshot

# Mobile
agent-browser set viewport 390 844
agent-browser open https://studysinc.click && agent-browser screenshot

# Authenticated pages (after login is fixed)
agent-browser open https://studysinc.click/dashboard && agent-browser screenshot
agent-browser open https://studysinc.click/groups && agent-browser screenshot
agent-browser open https://studysinc.click/calendar && agent-browser screenshot
agent-browser open https://studysinc.click/notifications && agent-browser screenshot
```

Prepared by: Kimi Code CLI

Files: see this directory and `more-screenshots/` for all screenshots referenced above.